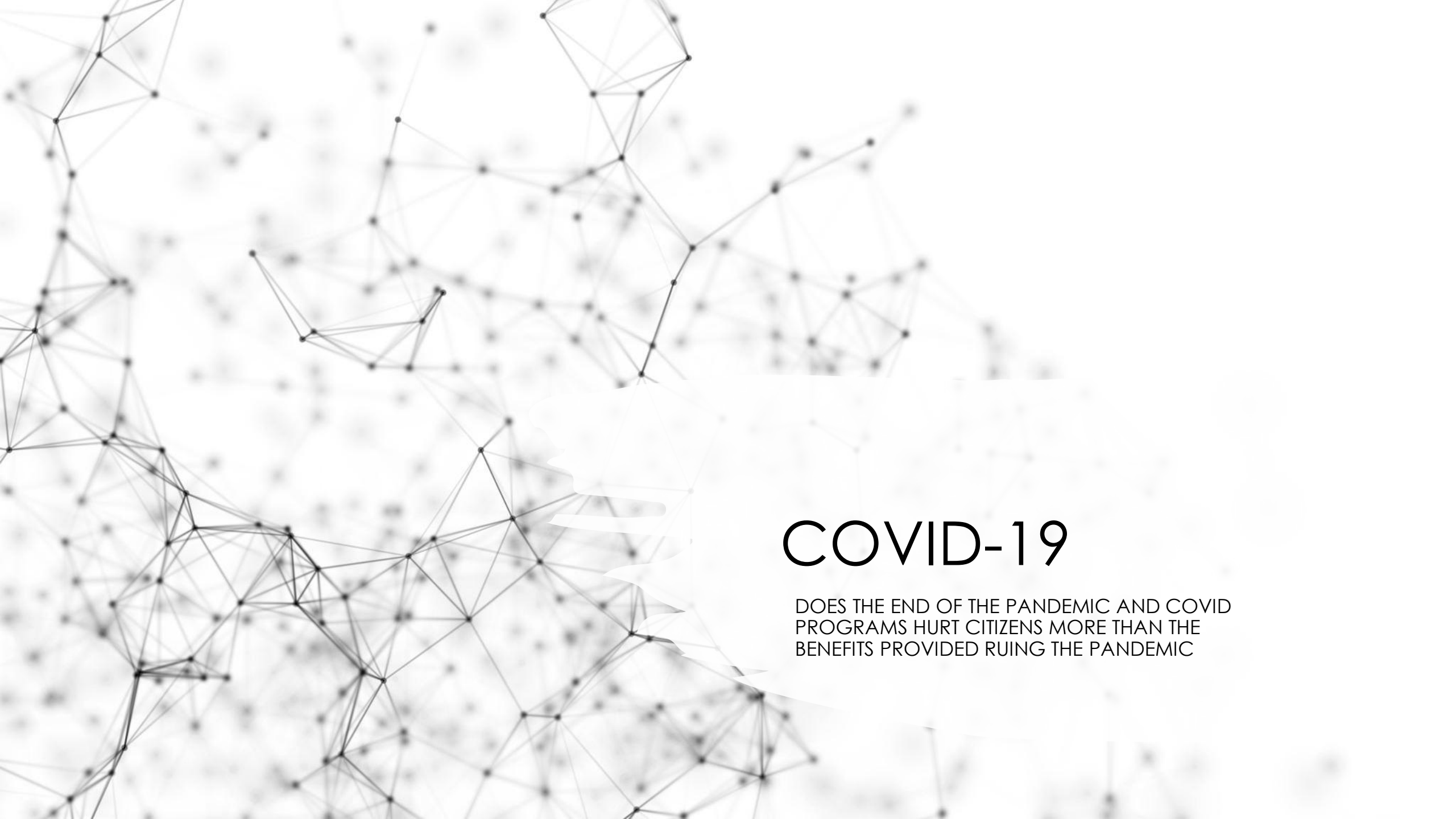




COVID-19

DOES THE END OF THE PANDEMIC AND COVID
PROGRAMS HURT CITIZENS MORE THAN THE
BENEFITS PROVIDED RUING THE PANDEMIC

Research Theory:

Is the official end of the COVID-19 Public Health Emergency (PHE) and removal of its associated benefits going to hurt US Citizens more than the benefits they provided during the three-year pandemic?

1. The Medicaid Unwind will remove people from health care that really need it.

- People on Medicaid that no longer qualify will be removed from coverage – leaving them without healthcare.
- An estimated 7-24 million citizens nationwide could lose coverage.
- Vulnerable populations and those that do not speak English as their primary languages are at higher risk of losing coverage due to limited resource available to assist them.

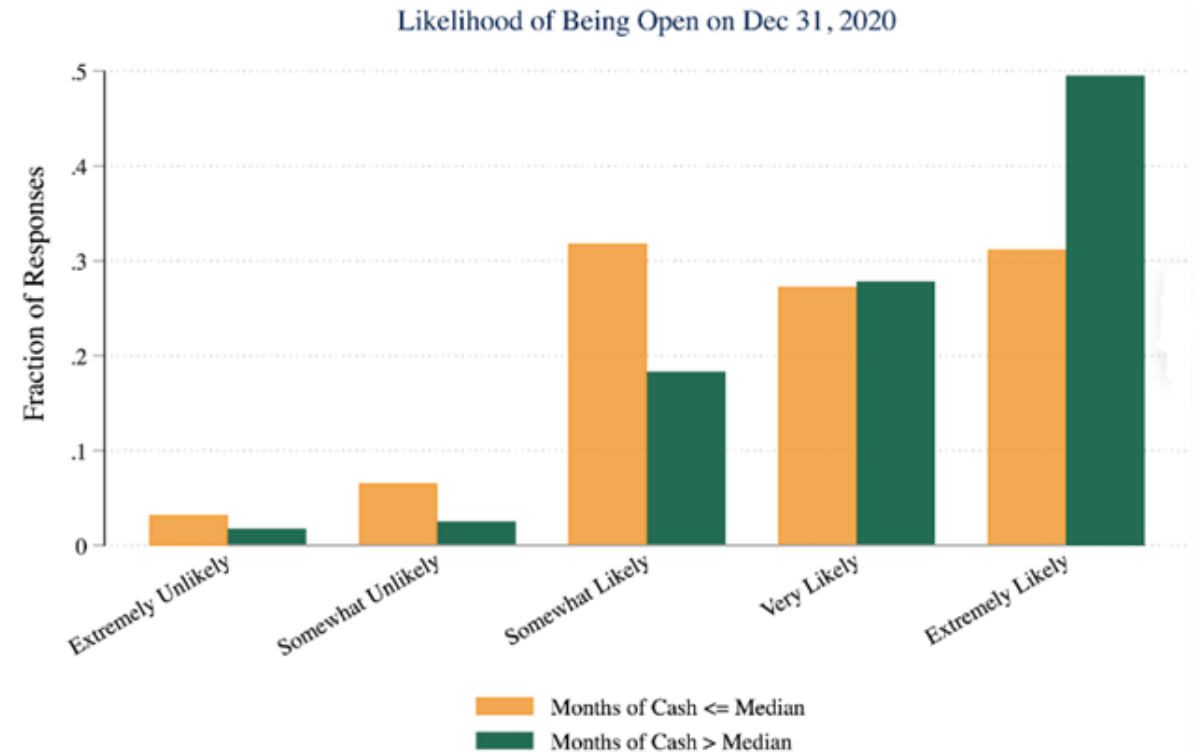
2. Not having free vaccinations available to all will increase disease spread.



- Many citizens will not have Medicaid.
- Vulnerable populations will not be able to get vaccinated.
- Cost will become a factor in virus spread control.

3. The business loans to essential businesses were only a band aid in helping them remain open.

Without the Federal assistance through loans, grants, and the paycheck protection program, many business would have closed by the end of the year.



Likelihood of remaining open or reopening by December. This figure displays the frequency of answers to a question about the likelihood of being open in December 2020. Responses are plotted based on whether the firm has more than the median number of months of cash on hand given their pre-COVID expenses.

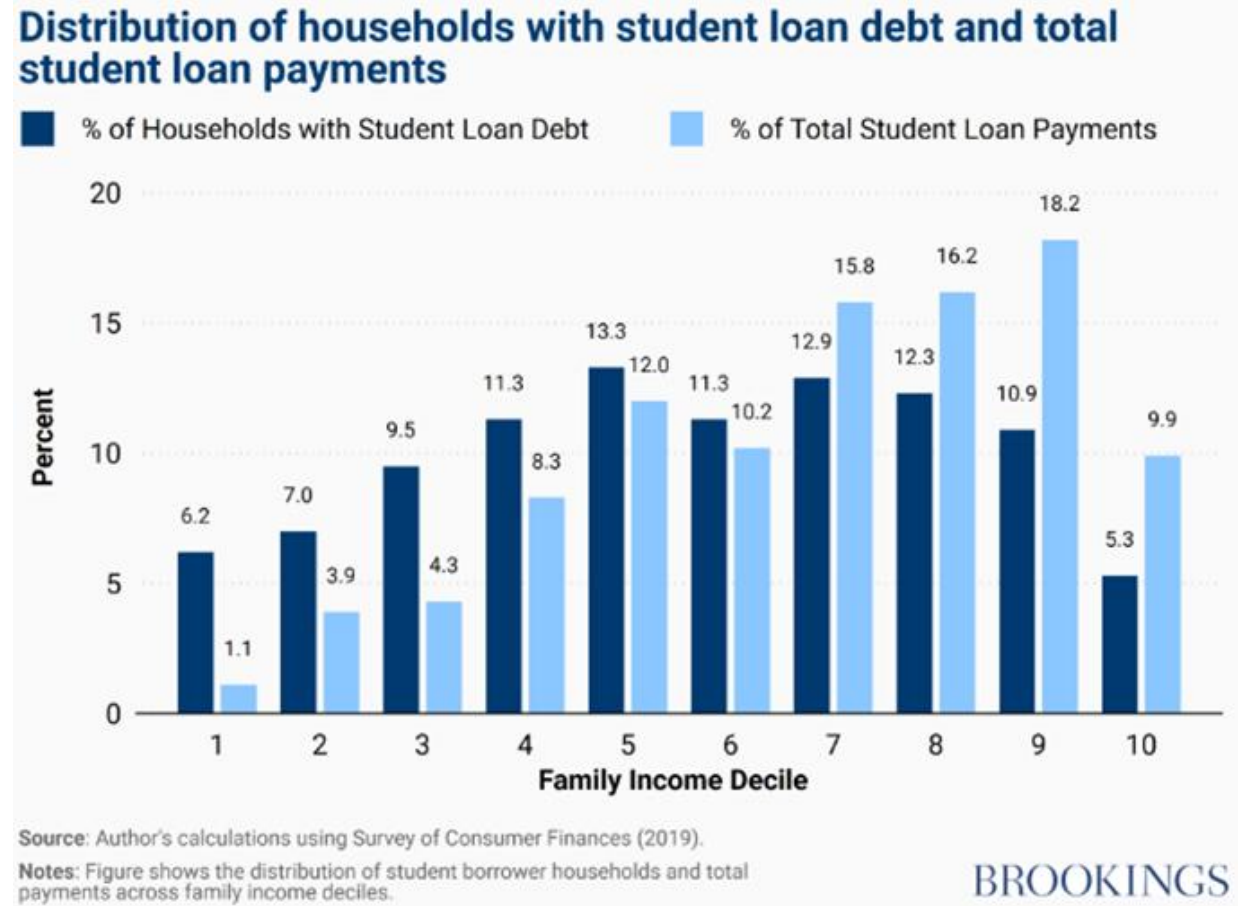
Businesses were surveyed between March 28 – April 4, 2020 regarding the likelihood of being open at the end of 2020.

4. Restarting student loan payments will hurt families financially.

1. Interest on loans was suspended by the President.
2. Payment suspension was announced the following week.
3. People have not been making payments for over 3 years.
4. Citizens have major concerns about the ability to begin repayment as their financial situation has changed.

5. The student loan discharge will only help a portion of the Citizens in the country.

Because of the distribution of student loans by income, those that have higher incomes will benefit more from the changes in student loan programs because they have higher debt amounts outstanding.



Conclusion

- The front-line response for the pandemic was testing and vaccination. It has been proven those were effective in controlling spread and severity of illness.
- From a financial perspective, those programs that supported small businesses were successful.
- The changes to the student loan programs have been the most confusing and their outcomes still have unknown impact on the citizens.

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